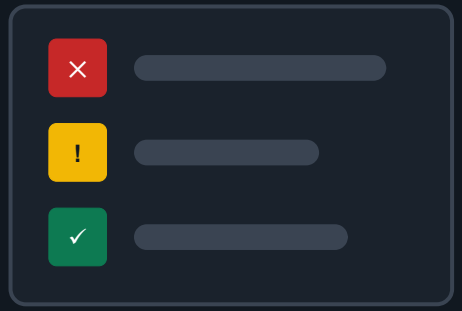
DEV 140 · DISCUSSION 5 · ACCESSIBILITY

Can Everyone Use Your Page?

Testing with WAVE, and fixing what it finds



WHY IT MATTERS

Everyone should be able to use your page

a11y

Short for “accessibility”: an a, then 11 letters, then a y.

a11y.coffee/intro

1 in 4+

U.S. adults have some type of disability.

CDC

95.9%

of the top 1,000,000 home pages fail automatic accessibility checks.

WebAIM Million, 2026

IT HELPS MORE PEOPLE THAN YOU THINK

Permanent
A blind student who uses a screen reader to hear the page.

Temporary
A broken wrist, so they can only use the keyboard for a while.

Situational
Anyone reading their phone outside in bright sunlight.

WAVE · A FREE ACCESSIBILITY CHECKER

WAVE marks every problem on your page

1. **Install the WAVE extension**
   Free at wave.webaim.org/extension (Chrome, Firefox, Edge).

2. **Open your page**
   Use Go Live in VS Code, so your page is running.

3. **Click the WAVE icon**
   Icons appear right on your page, and a sidebar shows the totals.

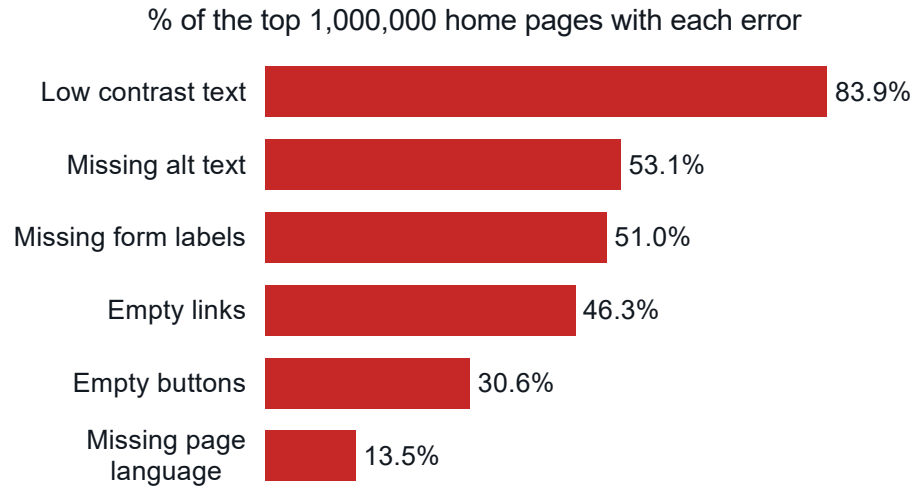
Page already on GitHub Pages? You can paste its URL into wave.webaim.org instead.

HOW TO READ THE WAVE SIDEBAR

- **Errors**
  Real problems. Fix these.
- **Contrast Errors**
  Text too faint to read. Fix these.
- **Alerts**
  Maybe a problem. You decide.
- **Features**
  Good things, like alt text.
- **Structure / ARIA**
  Headings, lists, landmarks. Info only.

WHAT WAVE FINDS MOST OFTEN

The same six mistakes are on most websites



Source: WebAIM Million 2026 (tested with WAVE) · a11y.coffee/quick-wins

WHAT IT'S LIKE FOR A USER

Low contrast
Faint text fades away for people with low vision, or in sunlight.

Missing alt text
A screen reader just says “image.” The meaning is lost.

Missing page language
A screen reader may read English in the wrong accent.

YOUR HOMEWORK

Find it, explain it, fix it, check again

1 FIND

Run WAVE on your own project page.

2 DOCUMENT

For 3 issues: the name, the element, and what WAVE said.

3 EXPLAIN

Who does each one affect, and how?

4 FIX

Fix your code. Run WAVE again: the icon is gone.

STUCK? GRAB A CUP AT A11Y.COFFEE

Quick Wins The six common errors, and how to fix each one.

Start Testing A short video on using WAVE.

THEN SUBMIT

- Your GitHub repo URL (commit and push first)
- A 150–200 word reflection: what you learned, not a list of fixes